

LOCUST

Salabhasana

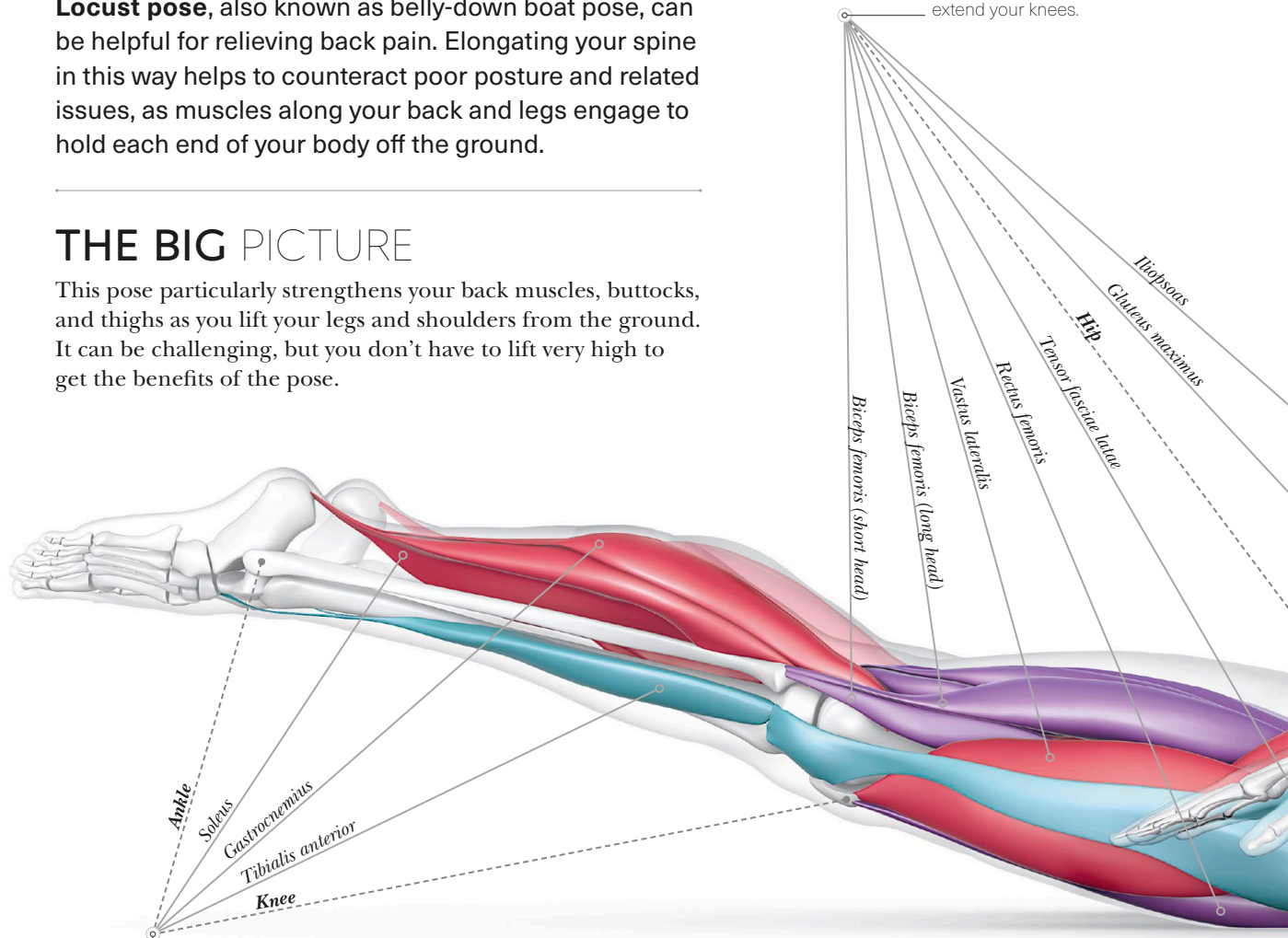
Locust pose, also known as belly-down boat pose, can be helpful for relieving back pain. Elongating your spine in this way helps to counteract poor posture and related issues, as muscles along your back and legs engage to hold each end of your body off the ground.

THE BIG PICTURE

This pose particularly strengthens your back muscles, buttocks, and thighs as you lift your legs and shoulders from the ground. It can be challenging, but you don't have to lift very high to get the benefits of the pose.

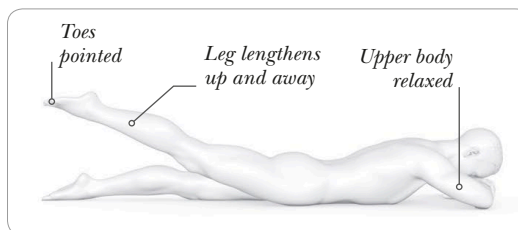
Thighs

Your **hip extensors** engage to help you lift your thighs, while your **hip flexors** stretch. Your **quadriceps** engage to extend your knees.



Lower legs

Your **gastrocnemius** and **soleus** engage to plantarflex your ankles while your **tibialis anterior** muscles and other **ankle dorsiflexors** are in a stretched position.



VARIATION

If you have neck issues, place your forehead on your hands and lift one leg at a time, trying to keep both of your front hip points toward the ground. Hold for several breaths, then switch legs.